Reading Analog Clocks to the Nearest Minute

Australian Curriculum v9.0 · Year 4
Maths
(Year 3 review skill)
AC9M3M04

🎒 Back to School 2027 Warm-Up

Name: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION

I can describe the relationship between hours and minutes on analog and digital clocks, and read time to the nearest minute.

I CAN...

- ✓ read the hour and minute hands
- ✓ write the time on a digital clock
- ✓ work out how many minutes pass between two times

KEY STRATEGY AND WORKED EXAMPLE



Short hand = hours. Long hand = minutes.
Each number is **5 minutes** (count by 5s), and each small mark is 1 minute.
60 minutes = 1 hour. When the long hand is on 9, that is 45 minutes.
This clock shows 3:45, which is also "quarter to 4".

A. TRY TOGETHER – USE THE STRATEGY

Write each time as a digital time.

1. 
Time: _____

2. 
Time: _____

3. 
Time: _____

4. 
Time: _____

B. CORE PRACTICE – SHOW YOUR THINKING

Read each clock to the nearest minute.

5. 
Time: _____

6. 
Time: _____

7. 
Time: _____

8. 
Time: _____

B. CORE PRACTICE (CONTINUED)

9 

Draw the hands to show **5:23**. Use a short hand for the hour and a long hand for the minutes.

Write each time as a digital time (10 and 11) and answer 12 and 13.

10 quarter past 8 = _____

11 twenty to 6 = _____

12 How many minutes from 4:15 to 4:50? _____

13 The bus arrives at 8:42. School starts at 9:00. How many minutes early? _____

C. CHALLENGE – REASON AND EXPLAIN

14 Footy training starts at **3:50 pm** and finishes at **5:15 pm**. How long is training? Show how you worked it out.

15 

Error Analysis. Liam says this clock shows **4:09** because the long hand points to 9. Explain his mistake and write the correct time.

16 Ella says, "There are 100 minutes in an hour, just like 100 cents in a dollar." Is she right? Explain.

Watch Out! After the half hour (30 minutes), the hour hand is nearly at the **next** number. Read the hour from the number the short hand has most recently passed.

💡 **Parent Tip:** Put a real analog clock in the kitchen and ask "What time is it?" at different points in the day. Practise counting by 5s around the clock face together.

🎯 My Term 1 Goal: This term I want to get better at _____

Answer and Teacher Page

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Name: _____ Date: _____

ANSWERS

1. 2:15

2. 6:30

3. 9:45

4. 11:10

5. 3:42

6. 7:18

7. 10:55

8. 12:07

9. Short hand just past 5 (a little over a third of the way to 6). Long hand 3 marks past the 4, which is 23 minutes.

10. 8:15

11. 5:40

12. 35 minutes

13. 18 minutes

14. 1 hour 25 minutes (85 minutes). 3:50 to 4:00 is 10 min, 4:00 to 5:00 is 60 min, 5:00 to 5:15 is 15 min. 10 + 60 + 15 = 85.

15. Liam read the long hand as 9 minutes. Each number is 5 minutes, so the 9 means 45 minutes (9 × 5). The time is 4:45 (quarter to 5).

16. No. There are 60 minutes in an hour. Cents are base 100 but time is base 60.

TEACHER NOTES

Common misconception: reading the minute hand as the number it points to (9 = 9 minutes instead of 45), and misreading the hour after the half hour.
Support: write 5, 10, 15 … 55 around the outside of a spare clock face to help skip counting.
Challenge marking: Q14 full marks for 1 hour 25 minutes or 85 minutes with working that bridges the hour. Q15 must connect the number 9 to 45 minutes. Q16 accept the idea of 60 minutes in an hour.
Australian Curriculum v9.0: AC9M3M04 (Year 3 review): describe the relationship between hours and minutes on analog and digital clocks, and read time to the nearest minute.